

eleventh symbol in the number system. Of all the five esoteric languages discussed in this section, I found Java2K the most annoying. So I leave the readers to experiment with this depressing language.

Joke languages

Joke languages are those exotic languages that do not serve any practical purpose other than the potential fun that can be had by dabbling with them. They are mostly generated from existing esoteric programming languages and not usable even in theoretical scenarios. Sometimes, joke languages are created by ingenious programmers to win certain contests. There are about hundred entries in the wiki page about joke languages with languages even named `###`, `***`, `COW`, `FIFTH`, etc. Many of these joke languages are not Turing complete and are not programming languages in the true sense. Joke languages include those used to generate programs that will serve just a single purpose. For example, a joke language called 99 is used only to generate the lyrics of the song '99 bottles of beer'. Joke languages also include languages like Malbolge, often considered the most difficult language ever invented to write an executable program with.

Non-English-based languages

Most well known languages have their character set based on the English alphabet. The overwhelming trend in computer science is to accept the dominance of English as the principal language. This is true even for languages that were developed in non-English speaking countries. For example, Python was developed in the Netherlands and Ruby in Japan, but even these languages adopted English-based keywords. But there is a small minority of languages that use non-English characters to form their tokens. Chinese programming languages, which were developed in the 1970s, are examples of languages using

non-English characters for token generation. It's interesting to know that there are programming language systems that use Indian languages like Hindi and Bengali to form their tokens. The Hindawi Indic programming system is a scalable system, which supports many programming paradigms. Hindi and Bengali C (Shaili Guru), C++ (Shaili Shraeni), OpenJava (Shaili Kritrim), lex (Shaili Shabda), yacc (Shaili Vyaaka), x86 Assembly (Shaili Yantrik), BASIC (Shaili Prathmik) and Logo (Shaili Robot) are the different languages supported by the Hindawi system. The system uses front-end compilers that translate the Hindi or Bengali code into its English equivalent, which in turn is compiled by the GCC compiler that acts as a back-end compiler. These kinds of non-English-based programming languages are very helpful to students without an English background.

This article has discussed some of the weirdest programming languages that have ever been created by humans. On the surface, it may seem that these languages are purposeless and a waste of time. But, in reality, they are useful in many different ways. They expand our knowledge of how programming languages work, they offer challenging puzzles to budding programmers and they also represent the real spirit of open source development. But the journey through exotic programming languages was slightly disappointing because none of the languages I have featured here were developed in our country. I believe that as a computing superpower we must make a contribution in every field of computing. 

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